

Aussie Primary Academy | Australian Curriculum v9.0 | Learn, Analyse and Practise

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION	sharpen ideas through precise verbs, elaborated tenses and purposeful adverb groups
KEY IDEA	Verb groups express action, time and aspect. Precise verbs reduce vague wording; elaborated tenses clarify time relationships; adverb groups add how, when, where or to what degree.
WORKED MODEL	Vague: The researchers did tests carefully. Sharper: The researchers had repeatedly tested the samples under controlled conditions before publishing the result.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I CAN

☐ choose precise verbs ☐ control tense ☐ add purposeful adverb groups ☐ explain effect

A. NOTICE AND IDENTIFY

1. Replace the vague verb: The wind went through the broken window.

2. Underline the full verb group: The team might have been monitoring the water overnight.

3. Label the adverb information: with extreme care; before sunrise; beside the inlet; almost completely.

B. APPLY AND EXPLAIN

4. Expand 'The engineer checked the bridge' to show repeated past action before another event.

5. Improve: The bird moved quickly across the sand. Choose a precise verb and remove unnecessary repetition.

6. Repair the tense shift: The class had planned the trial and records each result yesterday.

C. INDEPENDENT FLUENCY - CHECK AND CREATE

7. Write three versions of one action using simple past, past progressive and past perfect. Explain the time difference.

8. Edit one response: box the verb group, underline each adverb group and delete any detail that does not sharpen meaning.

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D. APPLY THE SKILL IN CONTEXT

9. Rewrite: The machine made a noise and then stopped. Use precise verbs and an adverb group to create urgency.

10. Write a four-sentence investigation report maintaining an appropriate tense while showing one earlier action.

11. Explain why your verb and tense choices suit an informative purpose.

E. REASON, EVALUATE AND TRANSFER

12. Compare 'looked', 'glanced', 'examined' and 'stared'. Rank by purpose or intensity and justify with contexts.

13. Error analysis: The writer adds four adverbs to every verb. Diagnose the problem and revise two sentences for precision.

F. STUDENT REVIEW - PROVE YOUR UNDERSTANDING

[] I can use precise verbs, elaborated tenses and adverb groups to sharpen ideas.

Circle one: independently | with one reminder | with support

Evidence from my work that proves I understand: _____

The most difficult decision was _____ because _____

One correction or improvement I made: _____

My next practice step: _____

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Accept equivalent responses when the student applies the targeted skill accurately and justifies the choice.

COMPLETE ANSWER KEY

1. Examples: swept, rushed, whistled or streamed, depending on context.
2. might have been monitoring.
3. manner; time; place; degree.
4. Example: The engineer had checked the bridge several times before the road reopened.
5. Example: The bird scurried across the sand.
6. The class had planned the trial and recorded each result yesterday.
- 7-8. Tenses must distinguish completed, ongoing and earlier-past action; annotation must identify complete groups.
9. Example: The machine shrieked without warning, then abruptly fell silent.
- 10-11. Check consistent report tense, one clear earlier action and purpose-based explanation.
12. Glanced=brief; looked=general; examined=careful; stared=long/intense. Context may alter order.
13. Adverb overload weakens precision; prefer strong verbs and retain only necessary information.

TEACHER CHECK AND NEXT STEP

[] Identifies the target feature accurately and cites evidence.

[] Applies the feature independently and explains its effect.

Next step: model one difficult item, complete one together, then repeat independently in a new context.

COMMON MISCONCEPTION / WATCH OUT

A longer verb group is not automatically better; every word must clarify time, modality or action.

Avoid adverb overload. A precise verb often communicates more efficiently.

EXTENSION AND RE-TEACH

Re-teach: model one item aloud, complete one together, then ask the student to explain an independent correction.

Extension: transfer the skill to a short authentic text and justify two deliberate language choices with quoted evidence.